



Cork and Crave

Wine Tasting



With Emma Grafton



The Court of Master Sommeliers

The Court of Master Sommeliers is an international examining body and educational organization dedicated to encouraging improved standards of beverage service and hospitality in hotels and restaurants.

Four Levels of Certification:

-  **Introductory Sommelier** — Entry-level certification covering basic theory.
-  **Certified Sommelier** — Demonstrates professional competency in service and tasting.
-  **Advanced Sommelier** — Advanced theory, blind tasting, and service standards.
-  **Master Sommelier** — The pinnacle of wine knowledge; fewer than 275 professionals worldwide have earned this title.

“The Master Sommelier Diploma Examination is widely considered one of the most difficult examinations in the world.”



Theory



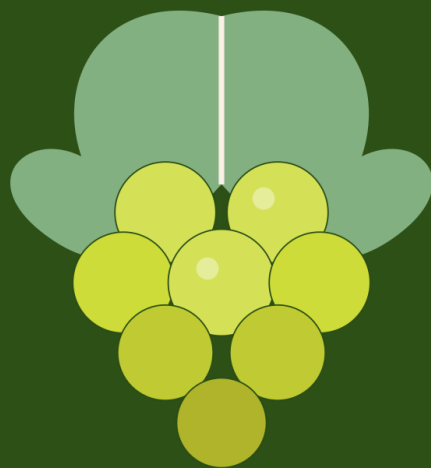
Blind Tasting



Service

Wine Tasting

<i>Tasting Notes</i>		1 Wine	2 Wine	3 Wine	4 Wine
	Appearance				
Visual Profile <i>Clarity • Intensity • Color</i>		_____	_____	_____	_____
	Nose				
Aromatic Profile <i>Intensity • Fruit • Floral • Spice</i>		_____	_____	_____	_____
	Palate				
Flavor Profile <i>Sweetness • Acidity • Tannin • Body • Finish</i>		_____	_____	_____	_____



Sauvignon Blanc



"The Crisp Classic"



Origin

Loire Valley, France



Acidity

High — crisp and refreshing



Flavor Profile

Citrus (lime, grapefruit), green herbs, gooseberry, passionfruit



Key Regions

Loire Valley (FR), Marlborough (NZ), Bordeaux (FR), Sonoma (USA)



Food Pairing

Seafood, goat cheese, salads, vegetables, herb-based dishes



Best Served

45–50°F (8–10°C)



Style

Unoaked; crisp & zesty

Old World & New World

Sauvignon Blanc



OLD WORLD

Key Region

Loire Valley, France (Sancerre, Pouilly-Fumé)

- ▲ Restrained, **mineral-driven** style
- ▲ Flinty, smoky "gunflint" minerality
- 🌿 Green herb, white flowers, citrus zest
- 🍷 Leaner, more delicate body
- ⚡ High acidity, crisp finish
- 🏡 Subtle terroir expression



NEW WORLD

Key Regions

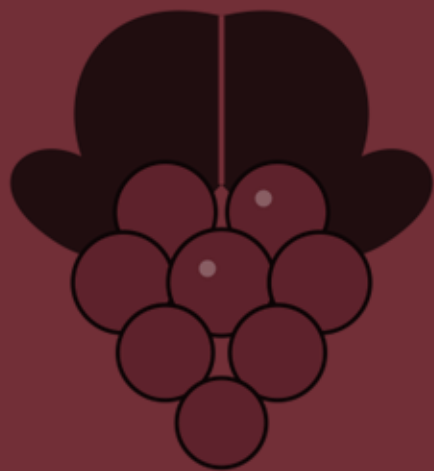
Marlborough, New Zealand; California; Chile

- ⚙️ Exuberant, aromatic, and **expressive**
- 🍌 Bold tropical fruit (passionfruit, guava, mango)
- 🌿 Intense lime, gooseberry, cut grass
- 🍷 Fuller body, more generous fruit
- ★ Vibrant acidity with fruit sweetness
- ♥️ Fruit-forward and immediately appealing

Mineral & Restrained

Style Spectrum

Tropical & Expressive



Cabernet Sauvignon



"The King of Red Wines"



Origin

Bordeaux, France (Cabernet Franc × Sauvignon Blanc cross)



Key Regions

Bordeaux (France), Napa Valley (USA), Coonawarra (Australia), Tuscany (Italy)



Flavor Profile

Dark fruits (blackcurrant, blackberry, plum), cedar, tobacco, graphite



Tannins

High — gives structure and aging potential



Food Pairing

Red meats, aged cheeses, lamb, hearty stews



Best Served

60–65°F (15–18°C)



Aging

10–30+ years

Old World & New World

Cabernet Sauvignon



OLD WORLD

Key Regions

Bordeaux, France (Left Bank: Médoc, Pauillac)

- 🍷 More **earthy, savory** profile
- 🍷 Herbal & mineral notes (graphite, wet gravel, bell pepper)
- ⚡ Higher acidity, firmer tannins
- 🍷 Leaner body, more restrained fruit
- 🍷 Oak: subtle, well-integrated (French Oak)
- 📍 Terroir-driven expression



NEW WORLD

Key Regions

Napa Valley (USA), Coonawarra (AUS), Chile

- ☀️ Riper, bolder **fruit-forward** style
- 🍏 Dark fruit focus (cassis, blackberry jam, cherry)
- 🍷 Lower acidity, softer / velvety tannins
- 🍷 Fuller body, higher alcohol
- 🌲 Oak: more prominent (vanilla, toast, smoke)
- 🌡️ Warmer climate ripeness

Earthy & Savory

Style Spectrum

Ripe & Fruit-Forward





Cheers!



"Wine is one of the most civilized things in the world"

— Ernest Hemingway